

version of this phone?" from picky women who have higher regard for a device's looks and appeal than its intended function? Why industrial designers and fashion brands don't collaborate more often is beyond comprehension, for it will surely help create better looking products than ever before, and technology will truly shine – literally and figuratively. Enough is enough: we need more women in technology, down with this guy's club perception of tech!

Women accessorise, men accessorise differently

Another aspect of technology where women tread a path less trodden by men is their ability to accessorize everything. From fancy iPhone cases beaded with glittery bits to stardust-splashed tablet handbags, from cute little matching earphones to colourful stickers that make sense to them alone, women have a penchant for, and the tireless ability to, accessorise and accentuate any tech gadget they can lay their hands on. Not just gadgets, but you see it in online games, too. If you have a Facebook account, and if you see a female inviting you to play Farmville, accept the invitation to just go and visit her farm. You'd be hard-pressed not to find an estate with different crops growing in various patterns, and every animal and farm object out on display. Farming alone isn't enough, farming with bling is equally important.

This drive and urge may escape a man's limited purview completely – who will work with any gadget, even one as ugly as a decomposing rat's tail, as long as it serves some purpose important to him. But thanks to women for single-handedly creating and sustaining the gadget accessories market. If only more tech manufacturers join hands with fashion designers to up the glitter and razzmatazz ante in tech gadgets, the world of tech will be a bed of roses and a jolly, colourful playground. Gucci cover for that new iPhone, anyone? No? How old-fashioned and manly of you! You need a makeover!

Spec matters

There's a reason why sales attendants in any LFR's digital section are predominantly men or why women browse these sections with "tech savvy" male tag-alongs who are only too eager to share their knowledge of tech and make the world a better place. Things like a gadget's specifications, its performance, and therefore its perceived

value are almost intuitive to men – they can grasp these concepts easily. Women, on the other hand, have trouble wrapping their heads around them (at least, for now). Sweeping generalisations are uncalled for, we agree, but in this context they're largely true based on our observations. While men may have a thousand boring questions on a device's hardware, upgradability, performance, applicability and price, women are



largely unconcerned by these frivolous details. They waste no time in looking past this tech jargon to select a device that looks good first, and then other features (integral to lesser mortals from the opposite sex) are up for consideration.

Bargaining power

Women are good with finances. One thing you can't take away from women is their ability to hunt for a bargain while out on a shopping spree. When both the seller and the buyer are from the fairer sex, negotiations can be fun to observe. Their verbal joust and ability to haggle while standing their respective ground is almost an education for young, hapless men passing by. So while a man knows that he obviously can't expect any freebies while purchasing the latest phone from a lucrative brand, women are oblivious to these sensibilities to some extent. They don't discriminate between items – whether it's shopping for curry leaves on the sidewalk or purchasing the latest tablet – the instinct to negotiate and get more out of every deal is natively ingrained in them. And since they succeed more often than not, if for nothing else, hats off to them for that.

Seduction

Men are seduced easily by tech gadgets, which leads them to make snap, impulsive decisions which may not be fully thought through. If a man goes in a tech store to browse for laptops, it's not strange to see him walk out with a laptop, a digital camera and a new TV. If he can't afford all of those, you can bet he's walked out with a fresh desire to save up for a new laptop, camera and TV.

Women, on the other hand, actually have emotional relationships with gadgets instead of sordid affairs like we men do. There's no lust for a new toy, or getting bored with one that's barely a year old. Instead there's an emotional farewell when a much-loved gadget dies. For this alone they're smarter and spend less on tech than men, who instead lust after every hot little thing with a big... er... touchscreen.



And no, you won't find them pulling dirty stunts like buying the latest gadget, saying "it's for you honey", knowing fully well that she isn't really ready to break up with her current device, and then happily offering to use it till she's ready, or so that it won't go to waste.

Addiction

Let's face it, men are clinically obsessed with anything tech to the point of insanity! Guys can game till the world's end, unaware of anything around them. They are also known to fiddle – with a PC, laptop, car, bike, etc. – for hours on end. This extreme level of immersion and dedication is something that only men can bring to the table. Sorry, gals. You lose the addiction battle, but take solace in the fact that you hold enough power to snap men out of it at will, with just the batting of your eyelids – provided he notices, that is. **[d]**